



Win 10 update alert

Real world testing is deciding the pace of Windows 10 anniversary update rollout.
<http://dgit.in/Win10Rollout>



Xbox One prototype

Microsoft accidentally sent a man in Miami, an Xbox One prototype instead of a laptop.
<http://dgit.in/MsXbxPT>



CAMERA

OnePlus 3

The OnePlus 3 may slightly edge past the competition here as well. The OnePlus 3 has an f/2.0 lens, and the 16MP Sony IMX298 sensor. It's not close to flagships like the Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge, but still punches above its weight. Under bright lights, it captures a lot of details and focuses fast, and accurately. However, it is slightly weak in low light. The OnePlus 3 reduces noise in images, and photos are quite sharp as well. The ISO levels are kept generally low and colours are a pleasantly warm.

It can create satisfactory images, but you would do well to keep your expectations in check. The software is smart enough to click with fast shutter speeds, so as to avoid blur, and the ISO levels are driven higher. This, though, creates some noise, but that can be dealt with.

Overall, the OnePlus 3's camera is extremely good, given its price, and would satisfy any buyer.

LeEco Le Max 2

In terms of specs, the Le Max 2 is the outright winner. It has a 21MP sensor, compared to the 16MP sensors on the others. The phone provides pretty good images under bright and well lit conditions. It is particularly good with dynamic range, and colours are fine, but not really vibrant or true to life.

The Le Max 2's camera produces quite a bit of noise under low light as well, but that can still be dealt with. Its major weakness is in focusing speeds. The camera takes quite a while to focus, which is a major issue when trying to take candid shots. Focussing is especially a problem when shooting videos. If you're moving about, the phone sometimes completely refuses to focus.

The Le Max 2's camera is better than the Xiaomi Mi 5, but it doesn't hold a candle to the OnePlus 3 and the ASUS Zenfone 3. It's an improvement from the original Le Max, but still not the best.

Xiaomi Mi 5

The camera is the Mi 5's weakest element. It has the same Sony IMX298 sensor as the OnePlus 3, but Xiaomi's algorithm is not as good. In bright sunlight and studio lights, the Mi 5 can take some brilliant photos. It's very good with the white balance and colours. However, photos aren't the sharpest that you can find.

This deteriorates quite a bit under low light. The Xiaomi Mi 5 loses most details in harsh conditions and the processing time is also driven up. It's a pretty disappointing camera, by Xiaomi standards. Especially because in the past Xiaomi has not disappointed with the camera on its other devices, even on the budget options. Considering that the camera was in fact hyped before the launch with camera samples being extensively shared, one would expect all aspects of the camera to be taken care of, but alas!

ASUS Zenfone 3

Unlike the Mi 5, the camera is the Zenfone 3's strongest suit. It also has the 16MP Sony IMX298 sensor, and loses out to the OnePlus 3 ever so slightly. Under bright and well lit conditions, the Zenfone 3 can produce good colours, albeit, not as pleasant as the OnePlus 3. The differences are slight and visible only when compared side-by-side. However, the OnePlus 3 does produce sharper photos, and is slightly faster too.

The Zenfone 3 is also equal to the OnePlus 3 under low light, but with its optimisation mode off. Turning this mode on, though, produces really bright photos, well beyond expectations. To be clear, photos become softer, but in extreme low light, the Zenfone 3 just takes a much brighter photo than the OnePlus 3, all thanks to the optimization mode that the camera packs.

Camera

Rear Camera	16MP
Front Camera	8MP
Normal light	4.5/5
Low light	3.5/5
Shutter response	4/5
Video recording	4/5
Front, overall quality	3.5/5

Camera

Rear Camera	21MP
Front Camera	8MP
Normal light	3.5/5
Low light	3.5/3
Shutter response	3.5/5
Video recording	3/5
Front, overall quality	3.5/5

Camera

Rear Camera	16MP
Front Camera	4MP
Normal light	4/5
Low light	3/5
Shutter response	4.5/5
Video recording	5/5
Front, overall quality	4/5

Camera

Rear Camera	16MP
Front Camera	8MP
Normal light	4.5/5
Low light	4.5/5
Shutter response	4/5
Video recording	3/5
Front, overall quality	4/5